



August 26, 2026

Dear Rank and Tenure Committee,

Dr. Vladislav D. Veksler is a true asset to Caldwell University, and I am delighted to support his promotion to Associate Professor. His enthusiasm, action-oriented approach, and optimistic outlook make him a transformative presence on this campus.

Dr. Veksler and I have collaborated on several initiatives since I started at Caldwell in Fall 2022. Together, we have advocated for the pooling of resources and manpower to enhance student research and computing experiences, as evidenced by joint submissions on Faculty Development Grants (Oct 2022, not awarded), ICUNJ Pfizer Grant (Dec 2022, awarded \$4000), and the creation of C-STEM, an interdisciplinary center for computational STEM research. During our early C-STEM days, we spent many evenings in the dining hall cafeteria eating dinner with our laptops open, brainstorming ways to not only meet our shared computing needs but allow for future growth. Since its creation, C-STEM has steadily grown to include 7 different labs across campus, an impressive feat that Dr. Veksler spearheaded.

Dr. Veksler plays an instrumental role in boosting student interest in computer science research and is seen as the face of the computer science department. His name is the first one that computer science students think of when they want career advice or opportunities to engage in the subject outside of class. I've served as a second reader for three Honors Projects advised by Dr. Veksler, and I can see firsthand why students clamor to work with him. He holds his students in high esteem, is very encouraging of new ideas, and gives students a lot of freedom to pursue their interests. His students have faced a lot of success competing in hackathons, presenting at local conferences, and publishing their research. Students appreciate and value Dr. Veksler's input and are energized by his clear excitement for their work. He has great rapport with his students, and you can spot him fist bumping students when they finish walking down the stage during Commencement every year.

In addition to enhancing student experiences, Dr. Veksler works to expand our curricular offerings. As an example, Dr. Veksler approached me with the idea of creating a Human-Computer Interaction minor, and we worked together to incorporate courses in computer science, psychology, and art. As a result, we now offer this interdisciplinary, future-oriented minor that helps students build skills highly valued in the contemporary workplace.

My experiences working with Dr. Veksler has been nothing but positive. He is accessible and responsive, open to feedback, and works hard to support this campus community. I can see myself engaging in fruitful collaborations with Dr. Veksler for decades to come.

Sincerely,

Lily Tsoi, Ph.D.

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